

Question ID: 71014fb1

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Advanced Math	Nonlinear equations in one variable and systems of equations in two variables	Hard

Question

$(x - 1)^2 = -4$

How many distinct real solutions does the given equation have?

Answer

- A. Exactly one
- B. Exactly two
- C. Infinitely many
- D. Zero

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. Any quantity that is positive or negative in value has a positive value when squared. Therefore, the left-hand side of the given equation is either positive or zero for any value of x . Since the right-hand side of the given equation is negative, there is no value of x for which the given equation is true. Thus, the number of distinct real solutions for the given equation is zero.

Choices A, B, and C are incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.